11-17 第1篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Middle-School Students Be Allowed to Keep a Small Pet at Home?

① On our class online board, a simple question last week received more replies than any other: "**Would your parents let you keep a small pet at home?**" Some answers were cheerful — "yes, my guinea pig is my best friend" — but many others were sad — "my mother says school is more important, so no." A hot debate followed, most of it between students and their parents, and almost none of it with a clear answer. After listening for two weeks, I believe the answer is not "no" and not "yes, as long as the child wants one"; it is a clearer middle: **middle-school students should be allowed to keep a small, suitable pet at home, once three simple conditions are met**.

② The first argument in favour is **quiet company**. A Grade 7 or 8 student spends many evenings alone at her desk, her parents still at work. A **small pet** — a rabbit, a goldfish, a cat, a cage of two parrots — brings a warm, non-judging presence into that quiet hour. According to a 2026 survey by the city youth centre, students who cared for a pet reported **lower loneliness** and **better night sleep** than those who did not. The child who has looked a living creature in the eye at 20:30 is, by 21:30, usually a little less tired inside.

③ The second argument is **responsibility**. A pet needs to be fed at roughly the same time every day, cleaned after, taken to the vet when ill, and never forgotten on a family holiday. None of this is a one-day job; it is a **365-day job**. A fourteen-year-old who has managed a pet for two years has quietly built a habit of **keeping a small promise every single day** — the same habit she will need for school projects, first jobs, and, one day, for her own family. Very few school subjects teach this lesson at the same depth.

④ The third argument is **gentle learning**. Caring for a living creature teaches small truths that no textbook covers well. A cat's nose tells you whether it has a small fever. A goldfish's silver colour goes dull when the tank water is too dirty. A rabbit that thumps its back leg is trying to tell you something. Children who grow up close to animals often develop **sharper observation** and **deeper empathy** — both are precious, and both are difficult to measure in any end-of-term test.

⑤ Of course, there are clear worries. First is **allergies**. A sister or a grandmother in the same flat may be allergic to fur; the pet, however loved, must not make another family member ill. Second is **time**. A student heading into Grade 9 has a heavier schedule. Third is **pet welfare**. A pet that is kept only for the child's joy, but cleaned up and fed by the

grandparents, is not really the child's pet — it is **the grandparents' pet in the child's clothing**.

⑥ These worries are real, but they do not kill the idea; they shape **three conditions**. Condition one: **no allergies** in any family member in the same flat, checked by a small home test before adopting. Condition two: a **written weekly care list**, signed by both child and parents, listing who does what on which evening — and a promise that the child will not suddenly stop in the busy term. Condition three: **a suitable species** for apartment life — small rabbits, cats, fish, hamsters, and small birds are all fine; large dogs, wild animals, turtles with expensive tanks, and any protected species are **out of the question**.

⑦ A further worry is **the Grade 9 year**. Some families argue, "Let the student keep a pet only before Grade 9; drop it in Grade 9 because of exam pressure." I disagree. Dropping a pet in the exam year sends a sad lesson: "When life gets difficult, we abandon small promises." In fact, the Grade 9 year is exactly when a student needs the **quiet, regular care** of a small pet the most — a ten-minute feed at 19:00 is a small rest for the mind between two long study hours. The pet does not slow her study; it **stabilises her spirit**.

⑧ My final answer, then, is clear. The question is not whether children are ready for pets — most are. The question is whether **adults are ready to build a home where the pet can be cared for fairly**. When the three conditions are kept, a small pet brings quiet company, teaches daily responsibility, and deepens gentle learning. Taotao the orange cat who lives on my grandmother's seventh floor did not make my cousin's maths scores go up. But on the evenings he sits next to her homework page, a small warm weight on her left elbow, she finishes two pages faster and smiles when she is done. **A good home, I believe, has room for one more heartbeat than just our own.**

注释： pet 宠物；allergy 过敏；responsibility 责任；empathy 共情；protected species 受保护物种

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What is the writer's main opinion?

A. Middle-school students should never keep pets at home.
B. Middle-school students should be allowed to keep a small, suitable pet at home, once three simple conditions are met.
C. All Chinese families must keep a cat.
D. Grade 9 students should drop their pets.

2. According to Paragraph ②, how does a pet help a student's evening?

A. By helping with homework.
B. By bringing a warm, non-judging presence; a 2026 city youth-centre survey found

that students who cared for a pet reported lower loneliness and better night sleep than those who did not.
C. By teaching English.
D. By cooking dinner.

3. Which of the following is NOT one of the writer's "three conditions" in Paragraph ⑥?

A. No allergies in any family member in the same flat, checked by a small home test.
B. A written weekly care list signed by both child and parents, promising the child will not suddenly stop in the busy term.
C. A suitable species for apartment life — small rabbits, cats, fish, hamsters, small birds.
D. The pet must be the most expensive in the neighbourhood.

4. How does the writer respond to the idea "drop the pet in Grade 9 because of exam pressure"?

A. Agrees: the pet must be given away.
B. Says Grade 9 is when the student needs quiet, regular care the most; a ten-minute feed is a small mental rest; the pet does not slow study — it stabilises the spirit; dropping the pet sends the sad lesson that when life gets hard we abandon small promises.
C. Says Grade 9 students should buy a second pet.
D. Says teachers should decide.

5. What does the writer mean by "A good home has room for one more heartbeat than just our own"?

A. A home must be very large.
B. A well-built family has emotional space for a small living creature beyond the human members; welcoming a pet with fair care deepens the family, not weakens it.
C. A home should have many clocks.
D. Every home must have a cat.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第①段末立论
【解析】核心主张直引。A、C、D 均偏。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题

【定位】第②段 "quiet company ... lower loneliness ... better night sleep"
【解析】调查数据直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】D
【题型】细节理解题（否定）
【定位】第⑥段三条条件
【解析】A、B、C 均在文中；D 不存在。故选 D。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑦段反驳
【解析】稳定心神 vs 抛弃承诺。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第⑧段末比喻
【解析】家之容量与情感。A、C、D 均偏离。故选 B。